5 if you're interested in more details about security groups (firewall rules).

10.4.3 Controlling data access

A database engine also implements access control itself. User management of the database engine has nothing to do with IAM users and access rights; it's only responsible for controlling access to the database. For example, you typically define a user for each application and grant rights to access and manipulate tables as needed. In the WordPress example, a database user called wordpress is created. The WordPress application authenticates itself to the database engine (MySQL, in this case) with this database user and a password.

IAM database authentication

AWS provides an IAM database authentication mechanism for MariaDB, MySQL, and PostgreSQL. With IAM database authentication, you no longer need to create users with a username and password in the database engine. Instead, you create a database user that uses a plug-in called `AWSAuthenticationPlugin` for authentication. You then log in to the database with the username and a token that is generated with your IAM identity. The token is valid for 15 minutes, so you have to renew it from time to time. You can learn more about IAM database authentication in the AWS documentation at http://mng.bz/z57r.

Typical use cases follow:

- Limiting write access to a few database users (e.g., only for an application)